



Presented by The High End



CARDBOARD PIRATE SHIP

Life-Size Blueprint — Full Hull, Mast & Sails

Build a life-size pirate ship your kids can sit inside and sail the living room.

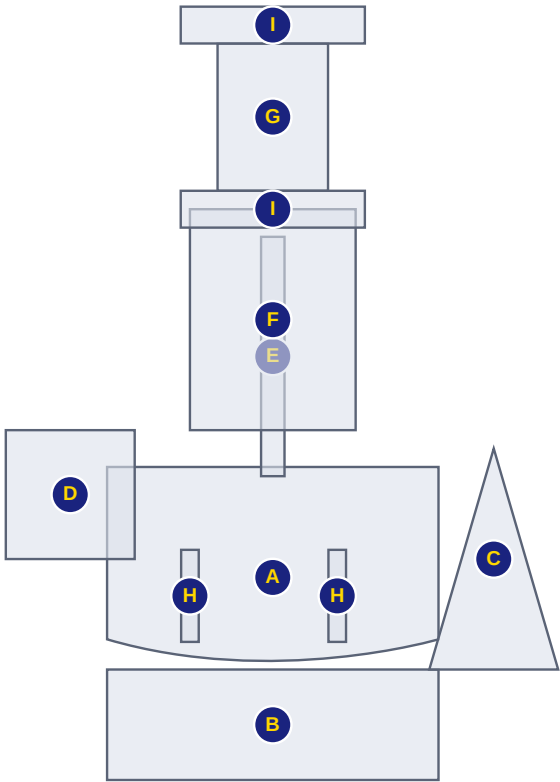
AGES 4–12	BOXES 4–5 Large Boxes	TIME 2–3 Hours	DIFF Intermediate **	PIECES 9 pcs
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CARDBOARD NEEDED:
4–5 Large Boxes (at least 24" × 36" (61 × 91 cm) each)

MISSION GOAL:
Build a pirate ship hull large enough for a child to sit inside, with a standing mast, 2 sails, 2 cannons, and rope rigging.

HOW IT ALL GOES TOGETHER — CARDBOARD PIRATE SHIP

The finished build, side view, with every part in the place the steps put it and the letter from its own cut-template page. Parts are drawn at their real size relative to each other, so if a letter is on this picture there is a page for it in this file. Pieces that roll into a tube are shown rolled, not laid flat.



EVERY PART IN THIS BUILD			
A	HULL SIDE 36" × 24" (91 × 61 cm)	CUT ×2	
C	BOW (FRONT POINT) 14" × 24" (36 × 61 cm)	CUT ×1	
E	MAST STRIP -> TUBE 26" × 8" (66 × 20 cm)	CUT ×2	
G	SAIL — SMALL 12" × 16" (30 × 41 cm)	CUT ×1	
I	SPAR (MAST CROSSBAR) 20" × 4" (51 × 10 cm)	CUT ×2	
			B HULL BOTTOM 36" × 12" (91 × 30 cm) CUT ×1
			D STERN PLATFORM 14" × 14" (36 × 36 cm) CUT ×1
			F SAIL — LARGE 18" × 24" (46 × 61 cm) CUT ×1
			H CANNON TUBE STRIP 10" × 6" (25 × 15 cm) CUT ×2

BUILD SEQUENCE — WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE AFTER EACH STEP

Each picture is the build once that step is finished. The part you just added is the ORANGE one. Grey is what was already there. Work down the page and yours should look like each picture in turn.

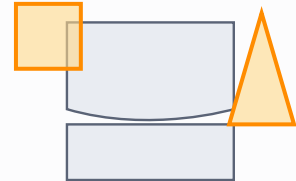
2 CUT THE HULL SIDES



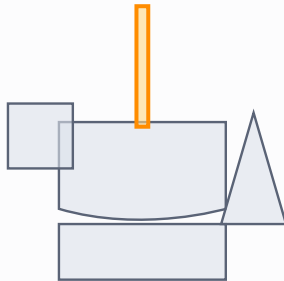
3 ASSEMBLE THE HULL



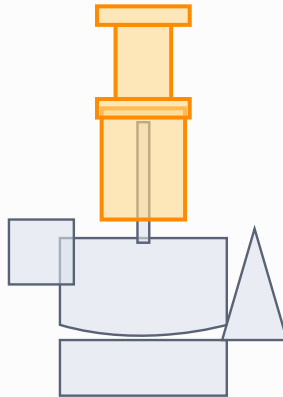
4 ADD BOW & STERN



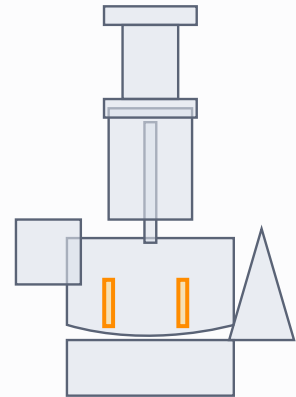
5 BUILD THE MAST



6 MOUNT SPARS & SAILS



7 MOUNT CANNONS





HULL SIDE

36" × 24" (91 × 61 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2

HULL SIDE

x2

0"4"8"12"16"20"24"28"32"

BASE EDGE — tape to Hull Bottom

4"3"12"16"20"

36" × 24" (91 × 61 cm)

Curved hull — straight top, bottom curving down to the centre

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:

Mark both bottom corners 5.3" up from the base. Draw a smooth curve from each mark down to the centre of the base — deepest in the middle, rising at both ends.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Score gentle curve at bottom



HULL BOTTOM

36" × 12" (91 × 30 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

HULL BOTTOM

x1

0"

4"

8"

12"

16"

20"

24"

28"

32"

FOLD UP — attaches to hull side

4"

3"

FOLD UP — attaches to hull side

36" × 12" (91 × 30 cm)

Connects both hull sides

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE:

Connects both hull sides



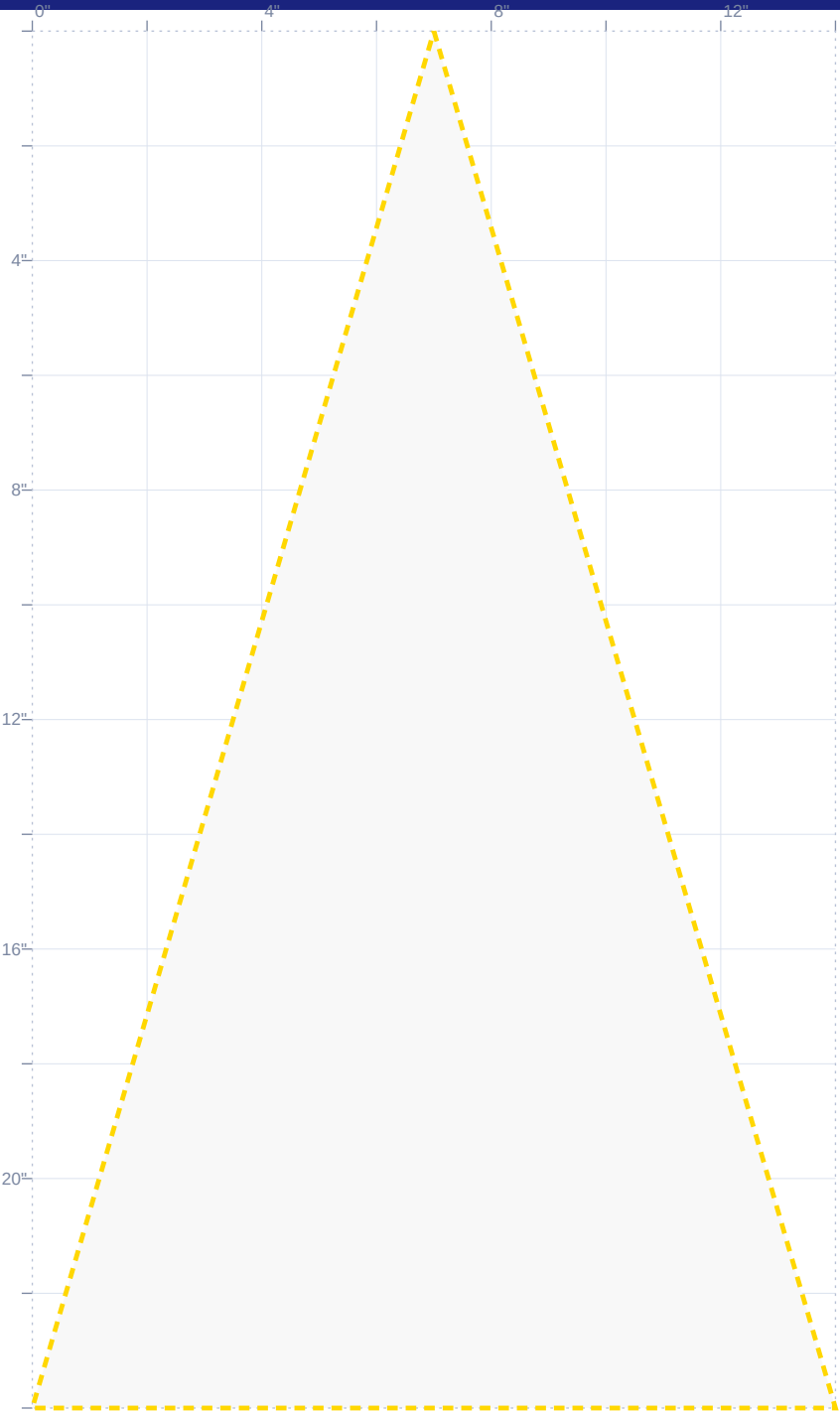
BOW (FRONT POINT)

14" × 24" (36 × 61 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

BOW (FRONT POINT)

x1



HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:

Mark the centre of the top edge. Draw a straight line from that point down to each bottom corner.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

14" × 24" (36 × 61 cm)

Triangle — full-width base, single point at the top

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

NOTE: Taper to point at top



STERN PLATFORM

14" x 14" (36 x 36 cm) | Cut x1

CUT
x1

STERN PLATFORM

x1

0"

4"

8"

12"

4"

8"

12"

12"

FOLD TAB — tape to hull top edges

14" x 14" (36 x 36 cm)
Raised rear deck

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Raised rear deck



MAST STRIP -> TUBE

26" x 8" (66 x 20 cm) | Cut x2

CUT
x2

MAST STRIP -> TUBE

0"4"8"12"16"20"24"

4"

ROLL

ROLL TIGHTLY from short edge. Tape every 2" as you roll.

26" x 8" (66 x 20 cm)

Two strips, overlapped 4" = a 4ft mast

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

ROLL — roll the cardboard tightly in this direction

NOTE: Two strips, overlapped 4" = a 4ft mast



SAIL — LARGE

18" × 24" (46 × 61 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

SAIL — LARGE

x1

0"4"8"12"16"

TOP EDGE — tape to spar

4"8"12"16"20"

18" × 24" (46 × 61 cm)
Draw skull + crossbones

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Draw skull + crossbones



SAIL — SMALL

12" × 16" (30 × 41 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

SAIL — SMALL

x1

0"

4"

8"

TOP EDGE — tape to upper spar

4"

8"

12"

12" × 16" (30 × 41 cm)

Top sail

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Top sail



CANNON TUBE STRIP

10" × 6" (25 × 15 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2

CANNON TUBE STRIP

x2

0" 4" 8"

4"

ROLL

ROLL INTO TUBE — tape seam solid

10" × 6" (25 × 15 cm)
Roll into short fat tube

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

ROLL — roll the cardboard tightly in this direction

NOTE: Roll into short fat tube



SPAR (MAST CROSSBAR)

20" x 4" (51 x 10 cm) | Cut x2

CUT
x2

SPAR (MAST CROSSBAR)

x2

0"4"8"12"16"

20" x 4" (51 x 10 cm)
Sails attach to these

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Sails attach to these

WHAT YOU NEED — CARDBOARD PIRATE SHIP

CARDBOARD PIECES — 9 TOTAL (4–5 Large Boxes (at least 24" × 36" (61 × 91 cm) each))

×2 **Hull Side**
36" × 24"
Score gentle curve at bottom

×1 **Hull Bottom**
36" × 12"
Connects both hull sides

×1 **Bow (Front Point)**
14" × 24"
Taper to point at top

×1 **Stern Platform**
14" × 14"
Raised rear deck

×2 **Mast Strip -> Tube**
26" × 8"
Two strips, overlapped 4" = a 4ft mast

×1 **Sail — Large**
18" × 24"
Draw skull + crossbones

×1 **Sail — Small**
12" × 16"
Top sail

×2 **Cannon Tube Strip**
10" × 6"
Roll into short fat tube

×2 **Spar (mast crossbar)**
20" × 4"
Sails attach to these

TOOLS & SUPPLIES

+ 4–5 large cardboard boxes (appliance-size preferred)

+ Box cutter — ADULT USE ONLY

+ Heavy scissors for kids

+ Packing tape (2+ rolls)

+ Brown + black markers or paint

+ String or yarn for rope rigging

+ Paper or light cardboard for sails

+ Ruler or tape measure

FUN FACT!

Real pirate ships were called galleons. Blackbeard's ship was called Queen Anne's Revenge!

CHALLENGE!

Crew challenge: add a working drawbridge! Cut the front of the hull so it folds down like a real gangplank.

1

STEP 1: FLATTEN & PLAN

Open and flatten all 4–5 boxes. Keep one sealed for the hull floor. Lay all pieces out to plan before cutting anything.

2

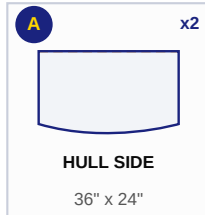
STEP 2: CUT THE HULL SIDES

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Cut 2 Hull Side pieces (36" × 24" (91 × 61 cm)). Score a gentle curved arc along the bottom edge (cut line shown on template) — this gives it a real ship shape. Stack both and compare — they must match.

SAFETY: Adult uses box cutter. Kids trace the cut line first with pencil.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



3

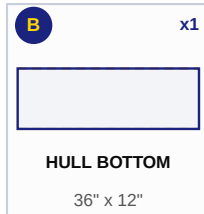
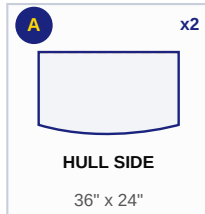
STEP 3: ASSEMBLE THE HULL

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Stand both hull sides upright, 16" (41 cm) apart. Lay the Hull Bottom connecting them at the base. Tape all inside seams with 3+ overlapping tape strips. Sit a child inside to test — add more tape until it holds steady.

SAFETY: Two people needed — one holds panels, one tapes corners.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

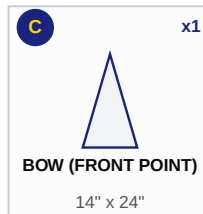
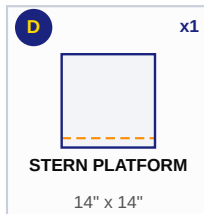
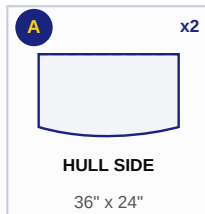


4

STEP 4: ADD BOW & STERN

Tape the Bow piece to the front — pointed end forward. Tape the Stern Platform across the top rear of both hull sides. The captain stands on the stern.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



5

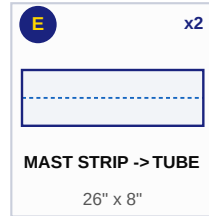
STEP 5: BUILD THE MAST

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Lay the two Mast Strips end to end, overlapping them by 4 inches, and tape the overlap solid on both sides - that gives you the full 4ft mast from boxes you can actually buy. Roll it tightly from the short edge — see the roll arrow on the template. Tape every 2 inches as you roll. When done, tape the full seam. Stand it center-ship. Cross-tape the base in an X to hold it upright.

SAFETY: Two people to hold mast upright while taping the base brace.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

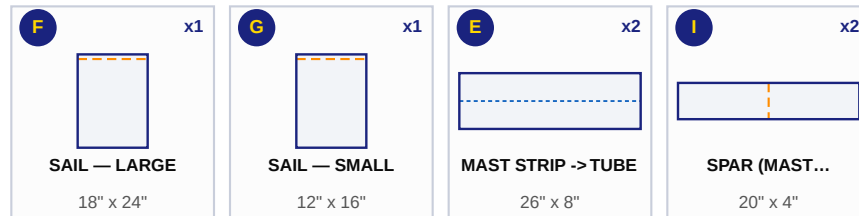


6

STEP 6: MOUNT SPARS & SAILS

Tape both Spars horizontally to the mast — one at the top, one 12" (30 cm) below. The fold marks on the template show the center balance point. Tape the Large Sail to the lower spar, Small Sail to the upper. Draw a skull & crossbones on the large sail.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

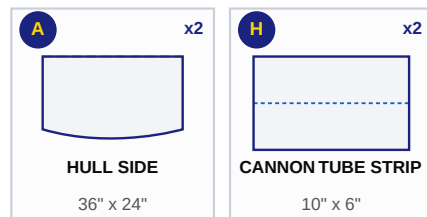


7

STEP 7: MOUNT CANNONS

Roll each Cannon Strip into a short fat tube (arrow on template). Poke a hole in each hull side wall and push a cannon through, angling outward. Tape from inside.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

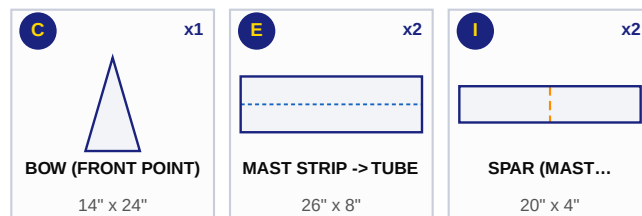


8

STEP 8: STRING THE RIGGING

Run string from the mast top down to the bow and stern. Add strings between spars. Pull taut and tape each end down. This is what makes it look like a real ship.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

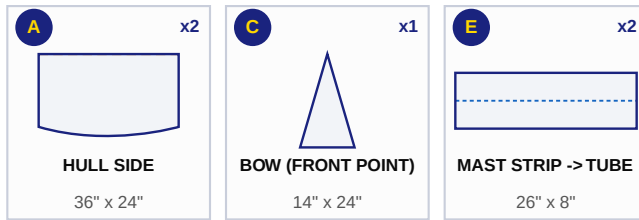


9

STEP 9: DECORATE

Draw wood plank lines in brown across the hull sides. Add a Jolly Roger flag at the mast top. Name your ship on the bow.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

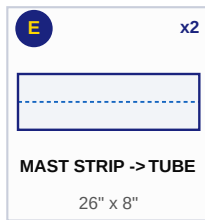


10

STEP 10: QUALITY CHECK

Child sits inside hull — holds their weight. Mast stands. Sails visible. Cannons mounted. Rigging strung. Compare to cover photo. That's the standard.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



QUALITY CHECK!

Does your build match the cover photo? Compare side by side before you call it done.

"Build It. Own It." — Tatum & Kash Cardboard Creations